



Partly sunny 67/48 • Tomorrow: Partly sunny 82/53 B16

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SATURDAY, MARCH 21, 2026 • \$4

Trump targets European tech rules

President campaigns to counter alleged censorship overseas

BY NAOMI NIX AND IAN DUNCAN

In early 2025, aides to Vice President JD Vance ordered a small office at the State Department to document how European regulators were censoring online speech.

Staffers launched an investigation focusing on the European Union’s Digital Services Act, a sweeping 2022 social media law requiring large tech companies to limit the spread of harmful or illegal speech on the continent.

The weeks-long investigation, details of which have not previously been reported, uncovered no records indicating censorship, according to two people familiar with the matter, who spoke on the condition of anonymity for fear of retribution.

“There is no evidence that Member States of the European Union are overreaching the DSA to censor and criminalize online content,” they wrote in conclusion.

Despite the finding, the Trump administration has pressed ahead with a wide-ranging State Department effort to crack down on what it alleges is widespread censorship in the E.U., according to documents reviewed by The Post and nine people involved or aware of the campaign, many of whom spoke on the condition of anonymity to protect their livelihoods.

It has banned some European researchers from entering the United States and dismantled federal programs intended to fight foreign disinformation campaigns. Behind the scenes, the administration has crafted a plan to allow American tech companies to skirt European rules, using the federal government’s powers to control exports, according to two of the people and documents.

The department is preparing to launch a website to host banned content. A teaser for the site, freedom.gov, includes a mounted Paul Revere-type figure

SEE TECH ON A12



ADAM GRAY/AP



GETTY IMAGES



HEIDI LEVINE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST



ULET IFANSASTI/GETTY IMAGES

Ramadan around the world

On Friday in places such as, clockwise from top left, Brooklyn, Jerusalem, Gaza City and Indonesia, Muslims bid farewell to the Islamic holy month of Ramadan with the celebration of the holiday Eid al-Fitr. Typically a time of joy and excitement, this year Eid al-Fitr came during a time of war, as the United States and Israel trade missile strikes with Iran in a conflict that is nearing its fourth week and has had consequences on a global scale.

DOJ seeks to have charges in Taylor raid dropped

BY MARK BERMAN AND PERRY STEIN

The Justice Department on Friday asked a federal judge to dismiss the remaining charges against two former Louisville police officers accused of wrongdoing in connection with the search that led to the fatal shooting of Breonna Taylor in 2020.

Taylor, a Black woman, was shot and killed by Louisville police who were carrying out a search warrant at her apartment in March 2020. Federal authori-

2020 search led to fatal shooting of Black woman in Louisville apartment

ties later brought civil rights charges against officers tied to the deadly raid, accusing two of them — Joshua Jaynes and Kyle Meany — of knowingly using false information to obtain the warrant used to justify the search.

Charges against Jaynes and

Meany — both of whom have noted in court papers that they were not present during the raid — had already been reduced twice before. In a court filing Friday, the Justice Department highlighted that history and wrote that it had determined the remaining case “should be dismissed in the interest of justice.” The agency also said it wanted the lingering charges dropped with prejudice, meaning they cannot be refiled later.

The filing came a little more than six years after Taylor’s death.

Officers serving the warrant at her apartment shortly after midnight broke down the door, and Taylor’s boyfriend, fearing intruders, fired a shot, striking one of the officers. Police opened fire in response, hitting Taylor six times. Taylor’s death, followed weeks later by George Floyd’s in Minneapolis, prompted immense protests and outrage.

During President Joe Biden’s administration, the Justice Department indicted four current and former Louisville officers in

SEE TAYLOR ON A6

Israelis in north stay put amid new Hezbollah hits

Rather than evacuation, Israel’s plan is to protect the bombed communities

BY LIOR SOROKA AND HEIDI LEVINE

KIBBUTZ MANARA, ISRAEL — Orna Weinberg, 60, moves through her house at night in darkness. Turning the lights on might attract the attention of the Hezbollah fighters just across the border.

For the past 20 days, Weinberg, a farmer and doula, has been living between the thud of Hezbollah missiles and the crack of Israeli artillery. But her overwhelming feeling, she says, is relief — to be home.

Weinberg, a married mother of four, is one of the 60,000 Israelis who were directed by the government after the Oct. 7, 2023 attack by Hamas to evacuate homes near

the Lebanese border when Hezbollah began firing and joined the war. This time, authorities are taking a different approach. “There is no evacuation,” Defense Minister Israel Katz said last week. “Everyone stays in their home.” The mission now, he said, is “to protect northern communities against raids and anti-tank fire.”

When Israel and Hezbollah agreed to a ceasefire in November 2024, Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said Israeli forces had set the Lebanese-based political and paramilitary force back “decades.” But since the United States and Israel began bombing Iran last month, Hezbollah has launched hundreds of rockets and drones at Israel per day.

The militants say they are avenging the death of their patron, Iranian supreme leader, Ayatollah Ali Khamenei, killed on the first day of the campaign. Israeli officials say they’re working to eliminate the group’s mili-

SEE IRAN ON A11



JEAN GUICHARD/GAMMA-RAPHO/GETTY IMAGES

Actor Chuck Norris was a martial arts champion before he starred in films and the TV show “Walker, Texas Ranger.”

CHUCK NORRIS | 1940-2026

As fighter, action star and meme, he was a kick

BY ELAHE IZADI AND VICTORIA CRAW

Chuck Norris, the actor and martial artist who played the leading role in long-running television series “Walker, Texas Ranger” has died, at age 86.

His family confirmed the news in a post on social media on Friday.

“It is with heavy hearts that our family shares the sudden passing of our beloved Chuck Norris yesterday morning,” the statement read. It did not give a reason for his death but said he had been recently hospitalized.

Mr. Norris, one of the most prominent Western martial arts champions, rose to stardom in the 1980s as an actor through action flicks, including “Missing in Action” and “Delta Force,” that showcased his fighting prowess and trademark roundhouse kick. He would go on to star in dozens of movies, which became fodder

for endless internet memes, introducing Mr. Norris to younger generations as a paragon of rugged masculinity.

Mr. Norris didn’t initially aim for a life in Hollywood. “I jumped into films when I was in my mid-30s. I had no experience, I’d never even done a high school play. And here I’m trying to jump into the acting field,” he told the Los Angeles Times in 1988. “... but from training myself over the years to think positively and to realize that if there was a will there was a way, I was able to achieve success. And by thinking if I could project a certain image on the screen, maybe that would overcome my inability as an actor at this point in time.”

Mr. Norris spun his film success into a long-running CBS series, “Walker, Texas Ranger,” the weekly crime-fighting drama that ran from 1993 to 2001. In it, Mr. Norris starred as a Cordell Walk-

SEE NORRIS ON A4

IN THE NEWS

Missiles shatter family Four women, all from one extended clan, are killed in a strike near a salon in the West Bank; they were the first Palestinian deaths in the Iran war. A10

Free speech case The Supreme Court ruled that an antiabortion activist can challenge a local law limiting protest areas. A6

THE NATION A Georgia woman was charged with murder after allegedly taking abortion pills. A6
Brandon Herrera knocked for videos on his gun-focused YouTube channel. A5

THE WORLD President Donald Trump makes joke about Pearl Harbor with the Japanese prime minister at his side. A9
U.S. military strike on a boat in the Pacific leaves two dead. A12

THE ECONOMY Another climb for oil prices shook stock markets, as hopes collapsed for a possible cut to interest rates this year by the Fed. A13
Small businesses are reeling from tariffs brace for spiking oil prices as a result of the actions in Iran. A13

STYLE The Gen Z pout is the younger generation’s disaffected evolution of the millennials’ “duck face” pose. B1

SPORTS Trump orders TV networks to protect the annual Army-Navy college football game. B7

THE REGION Video released by Fairfax police shows that an officer shot a man who police say was stabbing a third victim. B12
Concerns in mind With the arrival of Eid al-Fitr, the end of Ramadan comes with worries over what lies ahead for D.C.-area Muslims. B12

BUSINESS NEWS.....A13
COMICS.....B4
OBITUARIES.....B14
OPINION PAGES.....A15
TELEVISION.....B6
WORLD NEWS.....A9

CONTENT © 2026
The Washington Post
Year 149, No. 54527

